are etched in the vocabulary of the Indian army as ‘Maratha’ and ‘Mahar’ continue to be mentioned in the names of two infantry regiments. Mass migration from Ratnagiri has also contributed immensely to the rise of Mumbai. The interconnections are best viewed from the prism of village names in Ratnagiri. Dadar and Borivali are important train stations in Mumbai but are also names of villages in Ratnagiri. Similarly, many surnames ending with ‘kar’, such as Ambedkar and Mangeshkar, refer to ancestral villages in the greater Konkan region.

Ratnagiri is known to Indians for its famous Alphonso mangoes but its migration history suggests that it should also be known for *man goes*. In fact, Ratnagiri’s export of mangoes and manpower often collided with each other on the busy ferry steamers that plied between Mumbai and the Konkan. In the 1930s, a legislative debate took place on how passengers were being displaced by mango parcels in the month of May![9]

Brahmins, Bunts and Butter Dosas: Udupi in Karnataka

If you walk into a south Indian restaurant outside south India, there are high chances of you being in an Udupi restaurant. The look and feel of these restaurants is similar. The cashier sits at the entrance with a photograph of the founder or pictures of gods and goddesses on the wall behind him. A young man clears used utensils from the table into a bucket in one swoop as you take your seat and inspect the varieties of dosas and idlis on the menu. The waiter briskly memorizes your order and passes it on to the kitchen and a dish magically appears before you within five minutes. What you witness is not just fast food at its finest but also a product of the Great Indian Migration Wave which originated in Udupi district of coastal Karnataka.

Between 1901 and 2011, the sex ratio of Udupi district never fell below 1090 females per 1000 males, reflecting over a 100 years of mass male outmigration. Migrations on a large scale were triggered in the late 19th century by lower-caste *Holeya* labourers towards the coffee plantations of Kodagu (then Coorg) and the Malnad region of Karnataka. By the early